

have a USB port on the back anyway. Another quick tip, in the event of a power failure, plug that USB lamp into a portable power bank and you've got a handy-dandy emergency lamp. Sure, you can use your phone's LED as well, but now you can save it for something more useful, like playing Candy Crush.



### To the cloud!

Data black out is a vaguely persistent thorn in everyone's side. You know you have to do it, but you also know that it's going to be expensive and the archiving process is going to be dreadfully dull. Well, here's a quick fix for you, get yourself a Microsoft Office 365 Home sub-



scription. Why? You pay ₹499 a month, or a lump sum fee of ₹4,199 for the whole year and you get a licensed version of Microsoft Office (the first step to going legit) and 1TB of cloud storage each to five separate accounts. So you can have original Office installations on all of your personal computers. If that's not a steal we don't know what is.

With OneDrive, you get to access your data from anywhere, be it your phone, tablet, PC, etc. Uploading is also as easy as drag-and-drop so backing up your pictures for example, is simply a matter of dragging your pictures folder from its current location to the OneDrive folder on your PC. A quick and simple solution.

Just remember to keep illegal content away from your OneDrive folder and your data should be safe and accessible to you for as long as you're willing to pay for the subscription.

### Power struggle

Fighting over USB chargers must be the norm in most households by now, what with everyone carrying multiple devices and all that. Fear not! You needn't worry about power ever again if all you do is take the trouble to pick up a few wall sockets with USB adapters. These things come dirt cheap and all you have to do is replace your regular wall socket with one of these. You get USB power without the

hassle of a charger and you can place them all over the house at minimal cost.

Do remember that these USB chargers will only be as good as your electrical



connection and the manufacturer so try to pick up only good quality sockets or your precious devices will be fried before you're even aware that something's not right.

## INTELLIGENT IDIOT BOX

**S**mart TVs haven't really caught on as well as we expected, but that's also probably because smartening up a dumb TV is really as simple as purchasing a dongle. You get small and cheap Android dongles by the dozens now and all that you need to do is to plug one into your TV and suddenly you have all the power that and freedom that Android has to offer on a 60-inch screen (we charitably assume that you're that well off).

If it's only movies, videos, photos and YouTube that you want to experience on your TV however, a cheap Miracast streaming dongle or Chromecast should fit the bill perfectly. These little dongles can be had for as little as ₹2,500 and will let you stream content to your TV directly from your home.

Taking this idea these dongles



a step further, you can actually attach to something like an old LCD with HDMI support for example, and place it anywhere you like. Want a larger screen in the bathroom? How about the kitchen, or the bedroom? It's a brilliantly simple solution to a problem that you didn't even know you had!

## WOEFUL WIRELESS

**E**lectronic gadgets are so much a part of our lives that they might as well be embedded into our body and at the same time, those very same gadgets without high-speed Internet access will be like you trying to breathe in an oxygen-free environment.

A good wireless setup in your house (assuming that you have an adequately fast Internet connection) will go a long way in alleviating this burden.

### Routers

The simplest solution is to get yourself a decent 802.11ac router with dual band support (which should be available for under ₹5,000). 802.11ac means the newer devices will have access to high-speed wireless transfer speeds. Dual band support will